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FREE CHECKLIST · 2026 EDITION

First 90 Days Launch Checklist & Calendar

Now that you have everything to move forward with the launch of your new online store, let's see how a structured website launch checklist can make the countdown to launch date become...



7 pages · PDF

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7 short sections. Read it in order, or jump to the part you need today.

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Now that you have everything to move forward with the launch of your new online store, let's see how a structured website launch checklist can make the countdown to launch date become less fuzzy and more clearer with each step in this starter pack.

This 90-day calendar breaks down your journey into manageable weekly tasks, removing the guesswork and helping you launch confidently. Whether you're selling handmade crafts, dropshipping products, or offering digital downloads, this timeline works for absolute beginners on any platform.

01 Days 1-30: Foundation & Planning Phase

Your first month is about laying solid groundwork. Don't rush to build, rushing now means rebuilding later.

Week 1-2: Research & Decision Making

- Choose your niche based on passion AND market demand
- Research your target customers and their buying habits
- Decide on your business model (dropshipping, print-on-demand, handmade, wholesale)
- Select your eCommerce platform (Shopify, WooCommerce, Etsy, BigCommerce)
- Register your business name and secure matching domain

Week 3-4: Product & Supplier Setup

- Source or create your first 5-10 products (start small!)
- Negotiate with suppliers or set up manufacturing processes
- Calculate pricing that covers costs and generates profit
- Write compelling product descriptions highlighting benefits
- Take or source high-quality product photos

Toolkit Essential: Create a simple spreadsheet tracking product costs, pricing, and profit margins. This becomes your financial compass throughout your journey.

02 Days 31-60: Build & Design Phase

Month two is where your store comes to life. Your website launch checklist now shifts to creating the actual shopping experience.

Week 5-6: Store Design & Setup

- Choose and customize your store theme (keep it simple!)
- Set up essential pages: Home, Shop, About, Contact
- Configure payment gateways (start with PayPal and Stripe)
- Set up shipping zones and calculate accurate rates
- Create your logo and basic branding elements

Week 7–8: Content & Legal Requirements

- Write your legal pages (privacy policy, terms, return policy)
- Set up Google Analytics and Search Console
- Create email templates for order confirmations and shipping
- Build a basic FAQ page answering common questions
- Set up your business email address (avoid using Gmail)

Toolkit Essential: Use free tools like Canva for graphics, Grammarly for writing, and TinyPNG for image compression. These save money while maintaining quality.

03 Days 61-90: Testing & Launch Phase

The final month of your website launch checklist focuses on testing everything and attracting your first customers.

Week 9–10: Complete Testing

- Process test orders on desktop and mobile devices
- Check every link on your website works correctly
- Verify emails arrive in inbox (not spam folder)
- Test checkout with different payment methods
- Ask friends to review your store and report issues

Week 11: Pre-Launch Marketing

- Build your email list with a "coming soon" landing page
- Set up social media profiles and post regularly
- Create your first 3–5 blog posts for SEO
- Reach out to potential influencers or partners

- Prepare launch day promotions or discounts

Week 12: Launch & Initial Sales

- Go live on your chosen launch date
- Send announcement emails to your pre-launch list
- Post launch announcements across all social channels
- Monitor analytics and fix any immediate issues
- Respond quickly to first customer inquiries

Toolkit Essential: Keep a launch day checklist handy: verify all products are "published," disable test mode on payment processors, remove any "coming soon" banners, and announce your launch.

04 Your Essential Beginner Toolkit

Free Tools to Get Started:

- **Google Analytics:** Track visitor behavior and sales
- **Google Search Console:** Monitor search performance
- **Canva:** Create graphics and social media posts
- **Mailchimp (Free tier):** Build and manage email lists
- **Answer the Public:** Find customer questions for content ideas

Paid Tools Worth Investing In:

- **Professional domain:** ($10–15/year) builds credibility
- **Business email:** ($6–12/month) looks professional
- **Stock photo subscription:** ($29–49/month) if you can't photograph products

05 Post-Launch: Days 91 and Beyond

Your website launch checklist doesn't end at launch. The first 30 days after going live are crucial for gathering feedback and making improvements.

Focus on customer service excellence, collect reviews from early buyers, analyze your analytics to see what's working, adjust pricing or descriptions based on results, and continue creating content to drive organic traffic.

06 Common Beginner Mistakes to Avoid

Waiting for perfection: Launch with 5–10 good products, not 100 mediocre ones. You can always add more later.

Skipping mobile testing: Over 60% of shoppers browse on phones. If your store doesn't work on mobile, you've lost most potential customers.

No marketing plan: Building a store without a traffic strategy is like opening a shop in the desert. Plan how you'll attract visitors before launch day.

Ignoring legal requirements: Missing privacy policies or return information destroys trust and can lead to legal problems.

07 Ready to Start Your Journey?

This 90-day website launch checklist transforms the overwhelming process of starting an online store into achievable weekly goals. Break it down, check off tasks as you go, and celebrate small wins along the way.

Remember, every successful store owner started exactly where you are now—uncertain but willing to take the first step. Your first 90 days set the foundation for everything that follows.

At Shopinbos, we provide detailed guides, templates, and resources for every stage of your eCommerce journey. From choosing platforms to optimizing conversions, we help first-time sellers turn their online store dreams into profitable reality.

Download this checklist, print it out, and start with day one. Your future customers are waiting.

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Ready to make your first sale?

Rex builds your store with you in 5 minutes. Take card, transfer and pay on delivery, book riders, and let Peggy answer customers on WhatsApp.

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